

Writing to explain or advise

EXPLANATIONS AND PIECES OF ADVICE GIVE THE READER MORE THAN THE BASIC FACTS.

Writing to explain and writing to advise can be confused with writing to inform. However, explanations and pieces of advice include reasons, feelings, and suggestions, as well as information.

Extra explanation

An explanation gives reasons. For example, it can explain why or how an event has happened, or why someone feels a certain way.

Explaining experiences

People are sometimes asked to explain their views on a topic, or the reason an experience was important or difficult. These types of explanations should not only describe the topic or event, but also the feelings involved.

I've lost all my confidence

How and why

Explanations tell the reader how or why something happened, not just what happened. They use linking words and phrases to show cause and effect.

**this is because
as a result of this
therefore**

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Ask

STOP THE STENCH!

Dear Annie,
I have a serious problem with smelly feet. It sounds silly, but it has an impact on my entire life. Not only does the smell irritate me, but other people have started to notice and make jokes. I've lost all my confidence and I can't even go to my friends' houses anymore because I'm too frightened to take off my shoes. What can I do?

Anonymous, 14

Dear Anonymous,

Don't worry—you're not alone! Stinky feet are a common problem. This is because there are more sweat glands in the feet than anywhere else in the body. When your feet release sweat, bacteria on the skin break it down. This process releases that cheesy smell.